

SubConf is the annual conference of the Subversion community. SubConf 2009 was the third such event, held at Munich, Germany, from October 27 to 29, 2009. While it's a user conference where Subversion users from various parts of the world participate, it does feature developer hackathons where the project's core developers come together to discuss the roadmap, hack on code, et al. Developers also meet the users to get feedback, and study their requirements so that future releases can cater to these.

SubConf 2009 had 10 core Subversion developers at the conference venue—Stephen Butler, Stefan Sperling and Neels Hofmeyr (of Elego); Julian Foad of WANdisco; Greg Stein (a popular open source developer); Hyrum K. Wright (Subversion Corp); Lieven Govaerts, Bert Huijben (of The Competence Group), C. Michael Pilato and myself (from Collabnet, Inc).

All of us were locked up in a room (hackathon) at the conference hotel for three days, where we discussed various things related to Subversion development such as the Working Copy Next Generation (WC-NG) library, usage of a scratch pool, itertool in Subversion code base, the release roadmap, interesting issues to work on, etc. Of course, the hackathon was not just a discussion forum; we also undertook some really productive programming—there were approximately 70 commits to the Subversion

repository with close to +46696/-36666 lines of change!

The first day of the conference started officially in the evening around 7:00 pm with the Subversion Round Table, where users from various organisations posted their queries and feedback about the version control system (VCS). They also explored the possibilities of getting some features introduced in future releases of the VCS. This was a fruitful discussion. Every year this results in bringing in new requirements to the project, directly from the target audience.

On the second day of the conference we had many talks regarding VCS. Long-time Subversion developer (from Jan 2001) C. Michael Pilato delivered the keynote address. He spoke on the history of Subversion, the way the community works, why CollabNet chose to make Subversion an open source project, etc. The talk covered the legacy of the Subversion Community and the advancements it had gone through over the years.

Some of the talks delivered on the second and third day of the conference were as follows (there were even more talks, but they were not in English. See reference [4], [5] for presentation slides link):

- *Subversion Release Process* by Subversion release manager Hyrum Wright and Stefan Sperling
- *Bringing Subversion to the Java World* by Alexander Kitaev and Alexander Sinyushkin
- *WC-NG* (Subversion's new working copy management library) by Hyrum Wright
- *Comparing Apples to Oranges—Subversion, git and Mercurial* by Stefan Sperling and Stephen Butler
- *Moving from SVN to Mercurial* by Zsolt Koppany and Janos Koppany

SubConf 2009

A Report

Senthil Kumaran S, a full committer to the Subversion project, shares his experiences at the three-day conference held in Munich recently